



MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS

**National intervention of Romania presented by H.E. Bogdan Aurescu,
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at the

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United Nations General Assembly**

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**Mr. President of the General Assembly,
Mr. Secretary General,
Excellencies,
Ladies and gentlemen,**

We celebrate 75 years since the establishment of the United Nations and the adoption of its Charter as a codification of multilateralism. We all acknowledge the **UN's vital contribution** to the development of our societies, as well as its galvanizing role by fostering dialogue, cooperation and shared responsibility, on the basis of the universal values and principles enshrined in the UN Charter. These principles are just as relevant today as they were 75 years ago.

Romania remains a firm supporter of the **multilateral rules-based international order, with the UN at its core**. Romania is committed to cooperate for a safer future for all, by promoting sustainable development, respect for human rights, peace and security. This is the future we want!

The COVID-19 pandemic has demonstrated, once more, that **global challenges require common action**, solidarity and cooperation. We must show commitment to “*a quantum leap in collective engagement*”, as mentioned by the Secretary-General. Multilateralism is also essential in harnessing opportunities to **build back better and greener**, towards inclusive and sustainable economies, and societies where „*no one is left behind*”. In order to achieve that, we must continue **reforming the UN**, to make it more effective, efficient and fit for its purpose. That is the United Nations we need!

Vos Excellences,

La pandémie de COVID-19 a eu un impact profond dans tous les secteurs de nos vies. La **réponse globale de l'ONU à cette crise** met en exergue l'interdépendance des piliers économique, humanitaire, de sécurité et des droits de l'homme. Néanmoins, elle a révélé le besoin impératif de les traiter d'une manière holistique.

La pandémie a provoqué l'augmentation des clivages à travers le monde aussi que des tentatives d'affaiblissement de la démocratie. Toutefois, cette période a facilité la propagation de la désinformation et des informations fallacieuses, qui peuvent constituer des possibles vecteurs de propagation de la violence et l'extrémisme.

C'est donc le moment charnière pour transformer cette crise en une nouvelle opportunité et de revitaliser **l'agenda de sécurité et de la paix**, avec un fort accent mis sur la prévention des conflits et la consolidation des processus de paix. Nos efforts dans le cadre des opérations de paix doivent continuer avec une efficacité toujours plus accrue. Nous soutenons aussi une plus grande intégration du principe de **la responsabilité de protéger** dans les actions et projets axés sur la prévention.

La Roumanie contribue traditionnellement à la paix et à la sécurité mondiale. Nous avons participé à des opérations onusiennes de la paix autour du monde, de la République Démocratique du Congo au Soudan de Sud et Mali, ou Kosovo, et nous allons continuer de jouer notre rôle.

Nous sommes convaincus que la coopération entre les Nations Unies et les organisations régionales est un instrument essentiel afin de consolider la sécurité et le développement dans le monde. Nous sommes toujours préoccupés par la multitude des conflits non-résolus dans la région de la Mer Noire, qui affectent la stabilité et la coopération dans notre voisinage. Nous continuons à promouvoir la coopération entre les Nations Unies et les différentes organisations dans notre région, y compris en tant que Président en exercice de l'Organisation de la Coopération Économique de la Mer Noire.

Nous appuyons les efforts régionaux et internationaux de lutte contre le **terrorisme**, en accord avec les droits de l'homme et le droit humanitaire, ainsi que la prochaine révision de la Stratégie anti-terroriste mondiale des Nations Unies.

La Roumanie reste fermement engagée à maintenir un ordre international fondé sur des règles, à consolider l'architecture mondiale du contrôle des armements, non-prolifération et désarmement, tout en tenant compte du contexte de sécurité. Alors que nous célébrons le 50e anniversaire de l'entrée en vigueur du TNP (Traité sur la non-

prolifération des armes nucléaires) en 2020, la Roumanie encourage toutes les parties à adopter une approche tournée vers l'avenir, en faisant tout leur possible pour parvenir au compromis afin de renforcer l'intégrité du TNP dans tous ses piliers.

Ladies and gentlemen,

While hunger, youth unemployment and gender inequality are on the rise, more action is needed in order to fully implement the **2030 Agenda and the Sustainable Development Goals**. In line with the Secretary General's call, we have the responsibility to address these challenges globally and locally. We have to set adequate policies, budgets, institutions and regulatory frameworks. We also need to involve and listen to our fellow citizens, in order to achieve a better and more sustainable future for all. In Romania, a dedicated strategic document launched in 2018 – **The 2030 Reviewed National Strategy** – guides our action over the next 12 years in order to meet the 17 Sustainable Development Goals.

During the Decade of Action for the SDGs, we must also work together to protect our planet and ecosystems. We need to resort to a rational use of planetary resources when pursuing economic growth, in full respect for **biodiversity**. The Biodiversity Summit offers a unique opportunity to show ambition and accelerate action on biodiversity for sustainable development.

Firm action is also needed in order to tackle the **climate and environmental emergencies**. From rising sea levels to catastrophic weather events, we can no longer afford to ignore the risks of climate change. We all have a duty to the future generations to turn Glasgow COP26 into a success and to achieve the goals of the Paris Agreement.

The EU Green Deal is a token of our commitment in that regard and an example of good practice, but we, the European states and institutions, cannot succeed by ourselves. We must all do our part to achieve a just, clean, secure and climate-sound future.

Romania's objective by 2050 is to create a framework where the economic, social and environmental policies are interconnected and designed to ensure: *sustainable development, high living standards and the quality of the environment*.

Ladies and gentlemen,

The future we want is one in which **human rights** are promoted, protected and fulfilled. We must ensure inclusivity and accountability and harness the youth and civil society's engagement.

The *leaving no one behind* principle should also be valid for human rights, taking into account that the overwhelming majority of the SDGs are anchored in human rights instruments.

The COVID-19 pandemic is also taking its toll on human rights, deepening pre-existing inequalities and enhancing vulnerabilities. We must ensure that a comprehensive and consistent approach to human rights is at the core of all efforts for economic recovery.

Gender equality is central to all the Sustainable Development Goals. This year marks the 25th anniversary of the Beijing Declaration and its Platform for Action. Together, they define the most comprehensive and transformative global agenda for gender equality and women's empowerment. The future Generation Equality Forum should achieve tangible results on gender equality. **We must stand together for women's rights!** Gender equality and women's rights are essential to recovering faster and better from this pandemic.

Digital Technology is central to almost every aspect of the response to the pandemic and a prerequisite for the achievement of the SDGs. The development and use of Digital technologies, including Artificial Intelligence, based on ethical principles, must be human-centred. The promotion and protection of human rights, democracy, good governance, accountability and the rule of law must be provided offline and online. Thus we need a universal political commitment to digital security. The UN should galvanize the digital cooperation at global level and contribute to mobilizing all actors to ensure open, secure and affordable access to digital infrastructure for all.

The digital sector in Romania amounts to 6% of the GDP and is an important driver of growth and innovation. We see digitalization as an opportunity for everyone and a key component of our economic development. Romania's digital transformation aims to make our country less bureaucratic, more resilient, and more attractive for foreign investment. It also has the potential to turn Romania into a regional innovation hub.

The COVID-19 crisis has proven that **disinformation** and hostile actions in the information environment are threatening both international and human security, and they have to be effectively addressed. This crisis demonstrated the crucial need for access to reliable, accurate and science-based information. Thus, it has confirmed the role of **free, independent, accountable and pluralistic media** in strengthening transparency, accountability and trust.

The future we want is also a future of **solidarity**, in line with 2030 Agenda and the principle of *leaving no one behind*. One of the **main lessons we have learned** during the past months is the **crucial need for effective and innovative multilateral cooperation**. We have also learned that **the rules-based international order – on which multilateralism relies on** – must be upheld and strengthened, in order to effectively address these challenges.

Now, more than ever, we have acknowledged that **health** represents an investment in the future and is key to sustainable development. Our intensified efforts to achieving the SDGs will contribute largely to mitigate the negative effects of the COVID-19 crisis.

Romania **has therefore become part of “The Coronavirus Global Response” pledging initiative**. At the same time, we have re-oriented several projects this year towards responding to health emergencies, particularly in our Eastern Neighbourhood and in Sub-Saharan Africa. Romania has redirected more than half of its budget for international development cooperation to respond to COVID-19. We contribute to consolidating the institutional capacity of health systems, ensuring food security and sustainable water management, as well as countering fake news in the COVID-19 context.

Romania has included the **refugees** in the national public health coverage and is ensuring their access to all the necessary medical facilities. All persons who have received the refugee status or another form of international protection have been granted continued access to the national territory. This process continued even during the state of emergency caused by the COVID-19 outbreak, and these persons are included in the prevention programmes against COVID-19.

Romania pays particular attention **to youth**, especially as far as education and professional training are concerned. As such, we have more than doubled the number of scholarships offered to foreign citizens for the 2020-2021 academic year, with particular attention to Africa. We believe that by ensuring the continuity in youth training, we contribute to the materialization of the “build back better” principle.

In its current capacity as Presidency of the Community of Democracies, Romania has actively promoted the role of youth in democratic processes. The Bucharest Declaration, adopted at the 20th anniversary of the Community of Democracies hosted by my country in June this year, clearly states that – I quote: “*democracies are best equipped to mobilize and ensure that all elements of society work together, adapt to new circumstances, and maximize inclusive joint efforts, including full and meaningful participation of youth in decision-making*”. **Following, the CoD Youth Forum**

organized by Romania this July has confirmed that as democracies need to work together to deliver the best results, youth involvement is essential for our common future and for the welfare of our societies.

Excellences,

Pour conclure, *l'ONU dont nous avons besoin* doit assurer un multilatéralisme efficace et mobiliser toutes les parties prenantes, les gouvernements, les secteurs financiers et d'affaires, le monde universitaire et la société civile. Afin de trouver des solutions soutenables aux défis mondiaux actuels, nous devons entendre toutes les voix de notre société, les femmes et les filles, la jeunesse et les enfants, ainsi que les personnes en situations vulnérables.

L'avenir que nous voulons doit répondre à nos aspirations de paix, de liberté et de justice, d'égalité et de prospérité, de bonne santé et d'un environnement non-pollué – un avenir où les droits de l'homme, la démocratie et l'Etat de droit nous offrent un cadre adéquat pour réaliser nos aspirations.

Je saisis cette opportunité pour mentionner que la Roumanie célèbre elle-même, 65 ans depuis l'adhésion à l'ONU. Dans ce cadre, je voudrais réaffirmer notre engagement pour les valeurs universelles de notre Organisation et notre volonté de continuer à contribuer pour atteindre ses objectifs nobles.

Monsieur le Président de l'Assemblée Générale,

Je vous félicite pour les responsabilités importantes que vous avez assumées et je vous assure du plein appui et de la coopération de la Roumanie pendant la 75ème session de l'Assemblée Générale.

Merci pour votre attention !